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“INFLATION WILL RISE, JOBS WILL NOT INCREASE, CONSUMERS WILL BE HIT, AND THE AMERICANS WILL REVOLT.”

dairy. So, he may be feeling let down at the hands of his friend Modi. I always thought and continue to think that this Trump-Modi friendship is a fake.

So, the combination of these circumstances, I think, has led to Trump's prejudice against India and the consequential threat of such high tariffs.

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So, the global governance and trade are currently at the mercy

of US President's personal whim?

Yes. I think President Trump is random. How else can he claim that Canada may become the 51st state of the US or address former PM Trudeau as Governor Trudeau or ask the current PM Mark Carney to 'never say never' and so on? He said he wouldn't rule out military force to gain control of Greenland which is a territory with treaties with Denmark, which is

a NATO member and a friend of the US. So, he doesn't care for geopolitics or global economy. He doesn't care who is a friend and who is a foe.

And at the moment, I think, he doesn't regard India as a friend.

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What impact do you think President Trump's current tariff mania will have on the US?

He will reap the fruits of

his actions in the next year or two. Inflation is rising in the US. Reshoring, as he describes his efforts of bringing outsourced business back to the US, will not happen. Boards of the US companies are answerable to their shareholders, and not to the President. It's not easy to relocate labour intensive industries back to the US unless one wants to render them uncompetitive in the global market. So, the inflation will rise, jobs will not increase, consumers will be hit, and the Americans will revolt.

Moreover, the world will not keep quiet. Countries will band together minus the US, and take countermeasures. There is already a conversation of constituting an alternative trade body like the WTO without the US. Of course, it's an ambitious thought but it's being spoken about nevertheless.

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Do you think the Indian economy is dead, like Trump said?

We are the world's fourth largest economy well on our way to become the third. We are moderately thriving but my regret is that we could have grown faster but for a few factors. We were knocking on the doors of 8% growth and now, we are stuck at 6-7%. There are many reasons for this but that's a conversation for another time. **BT**